On the morning of November 19, I was waiting for Gorbachev at Villa Fleur d'Eau. When I was told his car had arrived, I hurried out to the porch and walked down several steps to greet him. He was dressed in a heavy topcoat and wearing a hat; I was hatless and in a suit. Why the press made a point of the fact that he was bundled up and I wasn't, I don't know—I suppose this was only one measure of the enormous attention being paid to the summit—but for whatever reason, the reporters who were keeping score gave me credit for winning the first round at the summit because I looked more casual than he did. (I hadn't planned it that way; the next time we were outdoors, I was wearing a topcoat—I didn't want to rub it in.)

As we shook hands for the first time, I had to admit—as Margaret Thatcher and Prime Minister Brian Mulroney of Canada predicted I would—that there was something likable about Gorbachev. There was warmth in his face and his style, not the coldness bordering on hatred I'd seen in most senior Soviet officials I'd met until then.

Our first session was scheduled to be a fifteen-minute one-on-one, get-acquainted meeting. It lasted almost an hour and we managed to break the ice, then joined the plenary meeting where each of us was backed up by a team of specialists and experts. I gave the floor to Gorbachev first and he went into a long pitch arguing that Americans had no reasons to mistrust the Soviets and that we should apply no preconditions to our discussions. As George Shultz had predicted, Gorbachev said he believed American munitions makers were the principal obstacle to peace on the American side: They were our ruling class, he suggested, and they kept our people fired up against the Soviets simply because they wanted to sell more weapons. Then he took off on U.S. think tanks that he said tried to do the same thing, and he complained that the United States had